

WS:

1. Email community@gitlab.com to initiate the appeal. Include your Discord username and a description of why you believe the ban was unjustified.
1. The moderation team will review your appeal and any associated documentation (e.g. admin notes on a member profile notes or a code of conduct issue). Once reviewed, the moderation team will decide to either uphold the ban, reduce the duration, or the lift the ban.
1. If the ban is reduced or lifted and a member returns to the server, any further violations of the community rules will be taken very seriously.

We appreciate your patience as we take time to look over appeal requests.

Reporting Unacceptable Behavior

To report unacceptable behavior or abuse, use the Discord reporting feature. See how to report content to Discord.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/e-mail.md

Overview

Workflow

Respond to e-mails sent to our community@, education@, merch@, opensource@, startups@ addresses. Deprecated e-mail aliases: movingtogitlab@, swag@shop.gitlab.com. You might still receive occasional e-mails from those addresses. If you do, please reply from the appropriate active e-mail address from within Zendesk.

{{% alert color="warning" %}}

<i class="fas fa-hand-point-right" aria-hidden="true" style="color: rgb(138, 109, 59);"></i> Please ensure that all e-mail traffic happens within Zendesk. This enables team members to collaborate on tickets, to bring visibility on conversations, and to make our response time metrics more accurate.

{{% /alert %}}

Best practices

Setting up aliases

If, for some reason you absolutely need to use your own @gitlab.com e-mail account to reply to a request otherwise tracked as a Zendesk ticket, please set up and use e-mail aliases as instructed on this video. This will make the conversation to be managed as a ticket in Zendesk, as opposed to privately on your personal inbox:

<figure class="videocontainer">

<iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/5bhcOQVznXE" frameborder="0" rel="0" allowfullscreen></iframe>

</figure>

Using templates

TBD

Using signatures

TBD

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/forum.md

The GitLab community forum (forum.gitlab.com) is a platform for users to register, ask questions, and collaborate, embodying GitLab's values of transparency and community contribution. It features a trust-based system, moderation workflows, and various tools for organizing discussions, such as categories and tags. The forum encourages engagement from both the wider community and GitLab team members, aiming to build a knowledge-sharing environment while maintaining a code of conduct and clear administrative processes.

Users

Registration and Login

Wider community members can register for an account on the community forum by using the Sign up button and choosing their preferred method (email, oauth, etc.).

For GitLab team members it is recommended to use the with GitLab oauth method. This will authenticate against GitLab.com as oauth provider, prefill the profile being created, and later serve as oauth login. This method also grants additional permissions, see the administration section for users below. Alternatively, manual sign-up using the gitlab.com address and setting up 2FA will work as well.

Code of Conduct and FAQ

Our Community Code of Conduct applies to the forum platform. When in doubt, flag posts which violate the Code of Conduct or are inappropriate in other ways (spam, advertising, etc.). Moderators can review the posts and take action while the posts are hidden from public viewing.

Discourse provides a general FAQ for users.

How to respond in the GitLab Forum

1. Visit the forum and navigate into the categories. Alternatively, use New, Latest and Unread search filters.
2. Write a response if you can, or involve a team member for assistance on the issue if you don't know how to engage or proceed. Troubleshooting questions and asking for details counts as a reply! Don't feel like you have to answer fully in one go.

Consider using some of the following resources to help get answers to questions:

- Search the forum for related topics - you may find a community member who has already solved something similar. You can loop them into the conversation or point the user to a thread that might be helpful
- Search GitLab's documentation for helpful information to aid in troubleshooting

Working alongside the wider community

In the GitLab Community Forum, most tech support and troubleshooting assistance comes from community members volunteering their time and knowledge to help others.

If you see a community member volunteering their time to help another community member, give their reply a :heart: to show appreciation for their contribution.

Flagging Inappropriate Content

If any GitLab team member sees a forum post that is inappropriate, abusive, spam, or a violation of our code of conduct, please flag the post by clicking the flag icon. The post is automatically hidden from public viewing and added to the moderation queue for review. If the flagging action requires more context or immediate actions, contact admins in the developer-relations Slack channel.

If immediate action to hide or redact private information is required, flag the post and then ping one of the admins in the developer-relations Slack channel.

Best Practices

- Always be courteous and generous, especially when a user is new to the forum. You can recognize new users (and dormant users) by the blue, temporary banner at the top of their posts.
- Add a welcome message when replying to new users. It could be as simple as "Hi, and welcome to the forum! :smile:" at the start of your post.
- Use the like button (the heart icon) as much as you can, to thank users for their input and to inspire other users to do the same.
- Use the solution checkbox button as much as you can, to indicate to others when a forum topic has an answer.
- Thank users publicly for providing answers to questions, especially when they are not in the GitLab Staff group.

Moderation

The moderation privileges should only be used to pin topics or make (global) announcements. Moderators share different responsibilities, and categories. If you need help or guidance, please reach out in the developer-relations Slack channel.

Reviews

Discourse implements an intelligent spam prevention system, which leads to users and posts behind hold for review. The same workflow applies when users flag a post manually. Items for review are indicated with a red count in the upper right menu, and can be access directly with the Review section.

- Topics unrelated to GitLab, DevOps, etc. and text with many external URLs often is spam.
 - Take action with Delete User > Delete and Block User. This also deletes the post.
- There are bots which copy the body text of another topic or reply, and create their own new topic with a new URL. Discourse detects them as New user typed their first post suspiciously fast, suspected bot or spammer behavior.
 - Take action with Delete User > Delete and Block User.
- False positives
 - Short replies such as Me too.
 - A copy-pasted question from a different platform.
 - A user without posts but a profile picture and a personal biography/website
 - Suggested action: Approve the posts/users.
- A post was flagged as CoC violation.
 - Review the post. When in doubt, ask in coc-violations in Slack.
 - Edit the post and follow the Code of Conduct Templates to replace the text.

User Review Tips

When the user account looks suspicious, these tips can help with verification:

- Search the user avatar picture to verify it is not a stock photo. TinEye provides a reverse image search.
- Compare username, real name, GitLab username (when provided), email address, biography for human input.
 - Bots and spam users often add URLs and text to their biography.
 - Different used names may indicate a fake profile.
- With admin permissions:
 - On the user profile, open the admin interface. Inspect the user profile's IP address with the Discourse built-in Whois lookup including geo location. When in doubt, use a search engine with whois <IP address> and also verify the ASN and its ISP. Sometimes a google search unveils them belonging to a fraud friendly environment, or other insightful details.

Moderator Specific Permissions

Click this link to view the Moderator Quick Start guide.

This guide explains Moderator permissions, expectations, and best practices.

Moderator Specific Non-Technical Contributions

- Welcome new members
- Check forum threads for an existing answer: if there is an answer already, consider liking it or marking as solved
- Reassign categories on the forum
- Add or create appropriate tags
- Look in the forum for answers that may have already been supplied in an existing thread
- Look in the Support Zendesk instance for answers that may have already been supplied in a ticket from Support
- Ask the poster initial troubleshooting questions like screenshots, error messages, etc.

General Moderator Best Practices

- Leave all interactions and replies open-ended. We want our forum users to feel like they can always come back and pick up the conversation.
- Consider gifting swag to forum users that contribute a lot or in a really exceptional way! Do this via a DM/private message.

Moderator Only Access

Below is a list of actions only forum Moderators can take in the Discourse platform. For this reason, at this time only GitLab Staff members are granted Moderator status.

Marking accepted solutions

Mark a response as an "accepted solution" in a situation where a single reply effectively answers or resolves a forum thread. Only the original poster and moderators have the ability to mark an answer in a forum thread. Please do this freely! It helps with SEO, and it helps our users know what questions have been answered.

Instructions

Click the ellipsis in the small grey toolbar on the post > click the checkbox.

Editing topics and posts

Sometimes users will accidentally post private information like license or API keys, emails addresses, etc. Publicly identifiable information needs to be redacted from the forum. You can also use this tool to redact inappropriate language or other Code of Conduct violations.

Instructions

If you need to edit a user's post for whatever reason, please private message the user in the forum letting them know that you have done so, and the reason why.

Click the ellipsis in the small grey toolbar on the post > click the pencil icon.

Instructions For Sending a Private Message

1. Click the user's avatar icon, user card will appear
2. Click the message button on the user card to draft private message

The edit history diff is only visible to moderators.

Viewing email addresses

For the sake of anonymity, only Forum Moderators can see the email address associated with a forum user's account.

Instructions

1. Click the user's avatar icon, user card will appear
2. Click the avatar icon on the user card to navigate to the user's profile

3. Click the show button in the user's profile

Drafting in/using the private Staff Category

This is not exclusive to Moderators, but you can use the Staff Category to draft new knowledge share articles, initiatives, whatever you need! You will notice the little lock symbol next to private categories.

Deleting topics and posts

We do not delete topics and posts in the forum, mainly due to the fact that this action can destroy trust. There are always exceptions to this rule - a good example is when spam posts sneak in. If you feel something needs to be deleted, you can always reach out to admins in private or in the developer-relations Slack channel and we can talk it through!

Instructions

Click the ellipsis in the small grey toolbar on the post > click the trash can icon.

Moving Posts To a New Thread

It's not uncommon that moderators will feel the need to move new posts out of old threads, or move posts to their own topic altogether. Please move new posts out of old topics when users try to bring topics a year or older back to life.

Instructions

1. Click wrench icon on right side of UI
2. Click select post in dropdown
3. Choose either select+below or select depending on how much of the conversation you want to move
4. Choose move to Fill out the popover accordingly
5. Click move to new topic

Workflow

Moderator and Admin Workflow

How and when to edit forum posts.

Generally, we do not edit other peoples' posts. If we see something that can be improved, we should reach out to them privately to ask them to change it. This helps us build trust with our community and with the GitLab team, since it shows them that they have the creative freedom and autonomy to post what they like on our forum.

That being said, there are instances when moderators can edit posts directly. Here are some examples and how to do it:

- Violation of GitLab's Code of Business Conduct & Ethics and Events Code of Conduct (Ex. redacting swear words, if they are unable or unwilling to edit it themselves)

- Redact private information (Ex. license keys, account info, email addresses, etc.)
- Editing can be achieved via the grey pencil icon in the post toolbar (... > pencil)

How and when to mark a solution in a thread.

- When there is a clear answer to the topic and/or question
- Marking the solution can be done via the grey checkbox icon in the post toolbar (... > checkbox)

How and when to delete a forum post or topic.

- Please do not delete other's posts. When necessary, message the user first, and let them have a chance to delete it themselves
- Deleting content for any reason is a breach of trust, which is something we are working hard to build in our forum community. If you feel like a post needs to be deleted, please reach out to an Admin, so the situation can be discussed.

Follow the relevant workflow depending on the question:

```
mermaid
graph TD
    A((Non-support)) --> B["Account"]
    B --> E["ping sales"]
    B --> F["Have they opened a support ticket?"]
    F --> G["ping supportgitlab-com"]
    F --> H["ping supportself-managed"]
    F --> I["Direct them to support.gitlab.com"]
    A --> J["GitLab vs Competitor"]
    J --> K["Find answer via DevOps tools page/blog and link"]
    J --> L["Link on competition"]
    A --> M["Feature Proposal"]
    M --> N["Link to the open issue"]
    M --> O["Ask them to open an issue"]
```

```
mermaid
graph TD
    A((Support)) --> B["What level of GitLab are they on?"]
    B --> C["Have they opened a support ticket?"]
    C --> E["Link them to the support portal"]
    C --> F["Have they provided the ticket number?"]
    F --> R["Ask them for the ticket number"]
    R --> F
    F --> G["Self-Managed or .com?"]
    G --> H["ping supportself-managed"]
    G --> I["ping supportgitlab-com"]
    G --> J["Ask what they're using"]
    J --> G
    B --> D["Is there an issue open already?"]
    D --> K["Link the issue"]
```

D --> |ask the following questions|L("Self-Managed or .com?")
L --> M("What version are they on?")
M --> N("Has this happened on a previous version?")
N --> O("How long have they been experiencing it?")
O --> P("What integrations do they have, if relevant?")
P --> |Questions answered|Q[ping relevant product channel]

Forum Community Response Workflow

Community response situations include preparing a forum topic as a draft in the Internal category.

Team members need to sign-up for a forum account in order to create a topic. The Internal category allows team members review and edit the draft together without it being available to the public.

After a forum topic is created in the Internal category, team members have the ability to edit the title, tags, description, post timestamp, and category.

- To edit the title, category, or tags of the topic, click the pencil icon on the top.
- To edit the description, use the pencil icon at the bottom of the topic next to 'Reply'. Note that the pencil icon may be collapsed within the ellipsis menu.
- Editing a topic description only is available for trust level 4 and moderators. Ask an administrator to update the team member trust level if necessary.

A sandbox topic to test editing is available here (internal).

Forum Banner Announcements

Steps for banner on Discourse:

1. Download design component to your computer
2. In Discourse navigate to Admin Panel > Customize > Themes > Top Navbar
3. Under uploads, click the Add+ button
4. Add your design
5. Click Edit CSS/HTML
6. Add mini banner CSS:

```
css
.mini-bannerimage {
  height: 60.5px;
  width: 720px;
  background-image: url($mini-banner);
  background-size: 100% 100%;
  margin: 0 auto;
}
```

7. Click After Header and add this div to make CSS work


```

html
<div class="main-banner">
  <a href="https://forum.gitlab.com">
    <div class="main-bannerimage"></div>
  </a>

  <a href="https://forum.gitlab.com/t/ci-cd-minutes-for-free-tier/40241" target="blank">
    <div class="mini-bannerimage"></div>
  </a>
</div>

```

8. Slight modifications may be needed depending on the size of the image

Administration

- Developer Relations DRIs: @sugaroverflow @dnsmichi
- Tech stack owners: @sugaroverflow @dnsmichi
- Forum staff members

Discourse Platform

The Discourse instance forum.gitlab.com is operated by the Discourse team on their SaaS platform. The Discourse platform was started as self-hosted instance in 2015, and later migrated to Discourse SaaS in February 2020. The domain is managed by the GitLab infrastructure team.

Updates and important security fixes are applied by the Discourse hosting team. Technical owners can reach out to their support team. For business organization and subscription updates, please open a confidential issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project.

In October 2021, the Discourse forum exceeded 1 million monthly page views. More metric reports can be created using the Admin dashboard.

User Trust Levels

Discourse uses trust levels to grant more trust permissions to users as they evolve on using and engaging on the forum platform. This trust system also helps to keep spam users away, ensuring a safe place to discuss and help each other.

- New users start at level 0, and can only post a few topics and replies, and need to engage by reading topics to earn trust level 1.
- Trust level 1 grants the permission to send DMs, upload images, flag posts, etc. as basic user.
- Members with trust level 2 have spent time on the forum, helped users with responses, receive and give likes, and read more about GitLab topics.
- Trust level 3 as a regular user means becoming a GitLab community evangelist with visiting often, leading the path with helpful responses, engaging with likes and feeling energized.
- Leaders with trust level 4 have earned their trust by staff team member nomination, helping with questions, engaging with likes, flagging posts to moderators, lending a hand to new users,

and overall collaborate closely with GitLab team members.

Nomination for Trust Level 4

Please open a new issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project and share the user profile URL and a detailed reason why they should be promoted to trust level 4. Assign the issue to technical owners using this quick action: /assign @dnsmichi @sugaroverflow. Administrators will review and reach out to nominated community members.

Team Member Trust Level

GitLab team members who signup using oauth, will automatically be added to the gitlab-team group, granting trust level 3. This group does not trigger any @-mention notifications in forum posts.

Administrators can promote team members to trust level 4 manually, for example when needed for community response workflows.

Core team members trust level

Core team members can be added to the core-team group through the Core team onboarding process. This action grants trust level 3. This group does not trigger any @-mention notifications in forum posts.

Categories

The forum categories allow to group posts by sections and topics. Users can also subscribe to category notifications. The top-level categories are inspired by the DevSecOps lifecycle, common questions about GitLab features, and community activities.

Categories are also shown in a dropdown when users follow the New topic action on the forum landing page. We try to keep the category list short and concise.

There are two categories serving a special purpose, they must not be removed:

- Internal is required for the community response workflow
- Staff is used by Discourse to manage site content and permissions (example: FAQ).

For requesting a new category, please review the following steps:

1. Do you want to filter specific topics, or subscribe to notifications? If yes, please consider using tags instead.
1. New categories should fit as subcategory into the existing top-level categories. We try to avoid bigger layout changes to avoid breaking contributor workflows.
1. Create a new issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project to discuss, and add details about forum DRIs, expected topic count, and impact. Assign the issue to technical owners using this quick action: /assign @dnsmichi @sugaroverflow.

Category Topic Templates

Discourse supports category topic templates, similar to GitLab description templates in issues/epics/MRs. Templates are used to guide users in providing all details for questions (configuration, steps to reproduce, versions, etc.) which enables forum contributors to help more efficiently. The categories focus on support ("How to use GitLab", etc.), community engagement and programs, GitLab University. A general catch-all category guides users to select specific categories as default template.

Administrators can edit each category, and navigate into Templates to modify the templates. Sub categories require a copy of the top-level templates, ensuring that all categories use templates by default. In the past, we had users specifically selecting categories without templates, creating new topics in the wrong place.

All templates are persisted in the discourse-assets Git repository, and provide templates for the top level categories.

Steps to update a category topic template:

1. Navigate into the category settings, and choose Templates.
1. Edit the template and preview the changes.
1. Save the template and test to create a new topic in the category.
1. Persist the changes in the discourse-assets Git repository.

Tags

Users can add tags to topics; higher trust levels also allow tag creation. Users can filter topics by tag, and subscribe to tag notifications too. This helps with specific workflows for docs and blog teams.

The tag group feedback includes the following tags:

- docs-feedback is used by the technical writing team to invite for docs.gitlab.com feedback.
- blog-feedback is embedded on the GitLab blog footer as CTA for feedback.

Settings

Administrators can modify the Discourse settings. Please open a new issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project to suggest, discuss and document changes. Note that plugins are installed by contacting Discourse Support.

The Only show overridden checkbox can be helpful to see modified settings. The most notable changes are documented below.

- Required: Title, site description, contact email, company name
- Branding: logo, favicon, etc.
- Basic setup: allow user locale, ga universal tracking code, top menu, category colors, fixed category positions, enable whispers, short title
- Login: GH login, oauth2 enabled (GitLab oauth via discourse-oauth2-basic)
- Users: reversed usernames, hide suspension reasons, use email for username and name suggestions
- Posting: min post/topic title length, do not allow uncategorized topics, post edit time

limit, do not show edit history to public, max reply history, newuser max replies/mentions per topic, newuser max links/embedded media/max attachments

- Email: alternative reply by email addresses
- Files: authorized extensions, do not download remote images to local, purge deleted uploads grace period days
- Security: Allow moderators to manage categories and groups, allowed iframes, enforce second factor for staff
- Spam: Hide post sensitivity, newuser spam host threshold, max new accounts per registration ip
- Rate Limits: rate limit new user create post
- User Preferences: Enable mailing list mode
- Plugins: allow solved on all topics, assign allowed on groups, data explorer enabled

User Admin

Admins can search for users, and verify the profiles when reviewing the moderation queue.

The groups are also managed in this section. Next to the default groups for trust levels and staff, custom groups have been created.

Badges

Discourse uses a gamification system where users can earn badges from forum activity, likes, and engaging with replies. The disco bot tutorial starts automatically for newly signed up users by sending them a direct message.

The trust levels also grant more forum permissions, and help prevent spam by limiting new users to a limited set to interactions.

Forum Spelunker is a custom badge which was granted to everyone helping answer and solve old forum topics in May 2020.

Customizations

Requires an administrative login. Open an issue with mockup design before changing the design.

- Themes: Top navbar menu navigation
- Colors
- User Fields asked during user registration: GitLab Username

Workflow for applying customizations:

1. Create a new issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project to propose changes, including design mockups, screenshots, etc.
1. Apply the changes to the custom theme, colors, etc.
1. Persist the changes for the custom theme in the discourse-assets project.
1. Changes to the loaded script URLs may require updates to the Content-Security-Policy settings. Please ask a forum admin.

Top navigation

The top navigation is managed in a custom theme with updated After header, Header, Head and CSS sections.

OneTrust

The OneTrust cookie banner is added as a theme component with custom CSS/HTML in the Head section.

Google Analytics

Google Analytics is configured using the GTM container ID setting in the Basic Setup section. Walkthrough for GA4 in this issue (internal)

API

Used by integrations, such as the GitLab Blog Bot.

Plugins

The Discourse subscription plan includes many plugins by default. The most common workflows are questions with answers, allowing to select one as solution, solving the topic (discourse-solved plugin).

General Administration Workflow

Most administrative tasks will be done from the Discourse Admin Dashboard. The dashboard provides metrics and dashboards for page views, user engagements, and community health stats.

Create a new issue in the Developer Advocate Meta Project to document changes in settings, handle abusive behavior and other administrative tasks.

The Logs section provides an audit log of all actions.

How to Grant Admin Permissions

To add an Admin:

1. Go to the list of forum users
1. Use the search box to find the user you want to grant admin permissions to
1. Click on the user to modify their profile
1. Verify that the user has Two-Factor Authentication enabled. If not, ask them to enable it in Profile > Preferences > Security > Two-Factor Authentication as this is a requirement for all staff members.
1. Scroll down to the Permissions section
1. Click on the Grant Admin button
1. An e-mail confirmation will be sent to the Admin that granted the permission (i.e. you). Go to your inbox and click on the link to confirm granting Admin permission to the user
1. If all went well, the Permissions > Admin? section on the user's profile admin should read Yes

Note: we would like to reserve only two or three Staff spots for forum Admins within our existing 15 total Staff spots.

How to Grant Moderator Permissions

If you want to add an Moderator:

1. Go to the list of forum users
1. Use the search box to find the user you want to grant moderator permissions to
1. Click on the user to modify their profile
1. Verify that the user has Two-Factor Authentication enabled. If not, ask them to enable it in Profile > Preferences > Security > Two-Factor Authentication as this is a requirement for all staff members.
1. Scroll down to the Permissions section
1. Click on the Grant Moderation button
1. Immediately the Permissions > Admin? section on the user's profile admin should read Yes

Note: we only have 15 Staff spots available with our current Discourse subscription. Please check with an Admin if you want to grant, or want to receive, moderator status.

Deprovisioning

As a provisioner, follow these steps to deprovision a GitLab team member who is being offboarded:

Revoke permissions and disable user

1. Go to the list of forum users
1. Use the search box to find the user you want to grant moderator permissions to
1. Click on the user to modify their profile
1. Reset trust level to 0 (new user)
1. Revoke moderator or admin permissions (if applicable)
1. Remove custom staff title (if applicable)
1. Remove from the gitlab-team group
1. If user account is authenticated with GitLab or uses a gitlab.com email address, suspend user.

Revoke permissions and keep account

If the team member wants to keep their account as a wider community member, follow these steps:

1. Go to the list of forum users
1. Use the search box to find the user you want to grant moderator permissions to
1. Click on the user to modify their profile
1. Ask them to change the email address to their private email.
1. Navigate to their user profile and select the Admin button on the right.
1. Verify that Primary Email / Secondary Emails do not contain a @gitlab.com email address.
1. Revoke Admin (if they were admins)
1. Revoke Moderator
1. Remove from all groups

1. Trust Level: 2: member

Offboarding core team members

1. Remove the user from the core team group.

Offboarding automation help

Follow the README in the internal team-member-offboarding-discourse project.

Projects

Fighting spam on Discourse

See the internal handbook for analysis, strategies and actions.

Connect with us in Slack

Join developer-relations.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/reddit.md

Overview

The r/gitlab subreddit is a place for questions, discussion, and support on all things GitLab.

Team members staff in r/gitlab

To request user flair for the GitLab subreddit, ping @devrel-team in the developer-relations Slack channel, and include your Reddit username. Your flair will read GitLab Staff.

Moderation

As a moderator on the GitLab subreddit, you have the ability to review spam, flagged posts or comments, and close issues. You can take actions in the moderation queue. Note that if you are a moderator who does not take mod actions occasionally, you will be marked inactive be restricted from certain moderator actions.

The r/gitlab moderators list includes Developer Relations team members and wider community members.

Subreddit Flairs

There are 3 post flairs in the GitLab subreddit - general question, support, and project.

General Questions:

This can include questions about GitLab as a product, comparing GitLab to competitors, hiring,

developer education, and questions about remote work at GitLab.

Use the involving experts workflow to engage experts in answering relevant questions.

Share [DevOps tools] pages in conversations comparing GitLab to other tools.

NOTE: Engagement in these conversations should be focused on providing facts, not opinions. Consider sharing DevOps tools in threads where users are looking for a tool to provide a solution to their problem.

Support:

Point the user to relevant docs, issues, or the forum for additional support.

If needed, ask an expert for help.

Project:

Use the involving experts workflow if feedback is directed to a specific team or functionally of GitLab.

Upvote general positive feedback.

Do not downvote critical feedback, unless it spreads misinformation. For example, don't just downvote because someone doesn't like the product or mentions a competitor.

Misinformation:

Downvote comments that spread misinformation.

Reply with evidence in the form of docs, issues, etc. with explanation of truth.

Best practices

Always be kind and understanding, no matter how the other person acts.

If you are new to Reddit, it may be useful to review this [beginner's guide].

Use your individual reddit account, not a shared company one. Feel free to use your personal (non-work) account if you feel comfortable. You can request the GitLab Staff user flair by pinging @devrel-team in the developer-relations Slack channel and include your Reddit username. User flair brings more visibility to GitLab team members and it's a transparent and effective way to let the wider community that you are part of the organization. It also makes comments seem more authentic and shows engagement in Reddit.

If you use Reddit a lot, it may be useful to create a separate, more professional (but still individual) work account to interact with the GitLab community as part of your role.

Brush up on your "reddiquette"

Make sure your comments are well formatted

Common Subreddits Mentioning GitLab

r/gitlab

r/learnprogramming

r/devops

r/git

r/Ubuntu

r/Terraform

r/coding

r/homelab

r/gnome
r/sysadmin
r/Python
r/selfhosted

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/stackoverflow.md

Overview

Stack Overflow is a place for questions, discussions, and support on all things GitLab.

General questions and tags

- Questions tagged gitlab

Stack Overflow GitLab Collective

Note: The sponsorship for Stack Overflow's GitLab Collective concluded on September 30, 2022 and the GitLab Collective was decommissioned. All of knowledge and submissions shared by our community will be retained. Articles and answers to questions about GitLab will be decoupled from the Collective and continue to exist in the public Stack Overflow knowledge base. For more details on decommissioning, visit this Stack Overflow article.

The GitLab Collective on Stack Overflow groups content related to GitLab in one place. The GitLab Collective creates a space to engage with our community on Stack Overflow through questions, answers, knowledge articles, and bulletins.

To request the GitLab Employee role, ping @devrel-team in the developer-relations Slack channel, and include your Stack Overflow username.

About the Collective

There are 4 features in Stack Overflow Collectives:

Questions:

- The primary and traditional content format on Stack Overflow is the question & answer format.
- Review guidelines for asking good questions.
- Collective admins and Recognized Members can mark answers as recommended.

Articles:

- Articles are intended for content in addition to the traditional Q&A format on Stack Overflow.
- They can be knowledge articles (broad or open ended explorations of a topic) or how-to guides (providing steps to accomplish a goal).
- Stack Overflow provides Article guidelines as well as a guide to submitting an article for users.

- We recommend submitting an outline for feedback before preparing the entire article.

Bulletins:

- Bulletins are updates about upcoming releases, events, or trainings posted by Collective admins.
- We use bulletins to share release notes, future meetups, and webinars.
- They are usually time sensitive and have an archive date.

Recognized Members

- Admins can promote users in the Collective to Recognized Members.
- Recognized Members can post articles, recommend answers, and have a "Recognized by GitLab" badge on their user card when interacting in the Collective.

Recognized Member Criteria

At GitLab, we believe that everyone can contribute and hope to provide a great experience for existing and new community members. Collective admins can promote users who are subject matter experts and/or helpful members of the Collective to Recognized Members.

A user must meet the following criteria to be promoted to a Recognized Member:

- be a member of the Collective for at least 30 days.
- have a minimum of 10 posts with at least 3 votes.
- have answered at least 5 questions.
- is not currently suspended.
- does not have a history of suspensions or problematic flags (i.e., spam, abusive, offensive, unwelcoming behavior).

Note: any Recognized Members who are suspended by Stack Overflow or violate GitLab's Community Code of Conduct will lose their Recognized Member status.

A user is recommended to meet the following requirements, but not required:

- offers detailed, helpful, and context-rich answers to others' questions.
- has submitted at least one Article to the Collective.
- has an account on the GitLab Forum and has at least 5 posts.

Nominations

To nominate someone to be a Recognized Member, please open an issue in the community operations tracker, share the user profile URL confirm that they meet the above requirements. Assign the issue the GitLab Collective admin using this quick action: /assign @sugaroverflow, who will review and reach out to nominees.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/swag.md

Assets

Google Sheet "Developer Relations Swag Coupon Codes & Delivery Tracking".

The file can be found in the Shared Google Drive Contributor Success, and is titled "[GitLab] Developer Relations Swag Coupon Codes & Delivery Tracking"

Swag Redemption portal

<https://gitlab-contributor.brilliantmade.com/>

Swag Redemption Portal

This portal shows the items you can claim, given the right coupon code. This is the link sent out to Wider Community Members.

Inventory Portal

This portal shows everything we've ordered and that is in stock & ready to ship.

Access can be requested through an access request. Mention "MyBrightSites" as the tech stack, and ping a manager from the Developer Relations department.

A list of the items in our inventory with the amount of items left to be claimed is accessible in the Google Sheet.

Sending Swag codes

If you are sending swag codes for the first time, you will need a personal access token with the readapi scope.

1. Request access to the Google Sheet "Developer Relations Swag Coupon Codes & Delivery Tracking".

1. Go to the tab "Issue rewards".

1. Add the Date, Username, Tier, Nominated by/cc (if applicable), and Link to contribution/event? fields for the recipient.

1. Highlight the Username field you entered and from the GitLab menu, select Create issues (highlight usernames)

1. It'll prompt you for your access token (personal, needs api access). Once entered, the macro will populate the rest of the fields and create an issue to reward the recipient in the Contributor Success rewards project.

Swag Nomination

If you think that a community member, contributor, or GitLab team member deserves a prize, nominate them for some swag! This also applies if you've reached an important milestone with your contributor (e.g First MR merged).

Tiers & Categories

Tiers

Currently we work with 3 value tiers. A coupon tier describes the roughly montary value you are able to claim in the gift shop.

Tier 1 Code

You can claim 3 items.

You have access to category 1 & 2

Expense range is on average \$25

Tier 2 Code

You can claim 4 items.

You have access to category 1,2 & 3

Expense range is on average \$50

Tier 3 Code

You can claim 6 items.

You have access to category 1,2 & 4

Expense range is on average \$100

Categories

Category 1

You can claim 3 items

Examples include Keychain, a set of pens, a journal or sticker tattoos.

The maximum monetary value of an item is between \$2-\$10

Category 2

You can claim 1 item

Examples include a GitLab T-Shirt

The maximum monetary value of an item is between \$10-\$15

Category 3

You can claim 1 item

Examples include a GitLab Hoodie

The maximum monetary value of an item is between \$15-\$35

Category 4

You can claim 1 item

Examples include a GitLab Hoodie or a Backpack

The maximum monetary value of an item is between \$30-\$65

For details on what is available in each category, please see the Inventory tab in the Google Sheet "Developer Relations Swag Coupon Codes & Delivery Tracking".

Swag Order Process overview

1. GitLab will requests new swag orders through emailing support@brilliantmade.com

Quantity of items

Date by which the inventory needs to be fulfilled

Which category this item belongs to

1. Boundless recommends planning swag requests 2.5 weeks in advance to order, especially for international shipping because there can be issues with customs.

1. Provide the basic order requirements, optionally with the requirement of a custom notecard or a dedicated redemption page.

1. Boundless places the order so that it's in the inventory.

1. GitLab decide in which category the items belong

1. Boundless adds the items to the store front.

External access to swag stores

There is a possibility to create access for, say, Meetup organizers, to self-service their required swag within our budget. Please file an access request and assign this to your manager.

Additional resources

Merchandise handling

Field Marketing

Email templates for sending swag links

Finding Community Member Contact information

FAQ

Is there any reason why Boundless would need to follow up if someone uses their coupon?

We will need a way to verify that swag has been expensed, to verify that our swag budget is not exceeded, or calculate how much budget is left i.e. for quarterly reports.

Once individuals have ordered swag, Boundless updates the spreadsheet to let us know if the coupon was redeemed. We need to make sure it gets delivered. There were some issues with deliveries recently - getting stuck at customs, etc. Sometimes it costs more than planned so they have to follow up and let us know if there's additional invoicing.

Is there a documented process how to request new codes?

Create an issue within the Developer Relations - Community Building project and assign to @sugaroverflow (Fatima), and ping @gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success

I don't understand why we should plan ahead

This is a strong request from Boundless. They need to move orders into the inventory so they need us to plan ahead and request number of items, which items, and by which date. After that, we can let contributors decide what to get.

If you'd like to make it easier, you could plan ahead for a lot of items, pay for the invoice and ask for the items to be added to an existing or new category

Can I have my own portal for my own program?

No, we simplified the historical situation on purpose as it was difficult to understand what we had in stock, difficult to send out items and a lot of busy work. The reason it is a single front, with Tiers & Categories allows us to scale and minimize human operations.

Can we send to an individual with an appreciation note?

Yes. You can request to add custom notecards to kits.

Boundless needs the verbiage to print on the card

Generally 3 x 5" with a GitLab logo on top

Who can help me with a declaration letter / support with getting Swag items released from customs?

Please email Brilliant team via email support@brilliantmade.com and they can assist you with getting Swag items cleared.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/team-budgets.md

<i class="fas fa-receipt" id="biz-tech-icons"></i> Team Budgets

We use Allocadia to manage team budgets. Due to a limited number of seats being allocated to the Marketing team, only a limited number has access to the tool from the Developer Relations team (sign-in from Okta is required). They are responsible for coordinating with the Developer Relations team to make sure that forecasts are properly added to Allocadia.

Quarterly Budget Planning Issues. As each quarter begins, the Developer Relations team creates a new issue using the quarterlybudgetplan issue template in the Community Ops project.

Annual Budget Planning Issues. In preparation for the year ahead, the Developer Relations team creates a new epic that then links to the quarterly planning issues.

Current epic: FY22 Developer Relations Budget Planning.

Allocadia Workaround

As a workaround for easier collaboration, those with Allocadia access do regular exports of the budget into a Google Spreadsheet by downloading the Developer Relations budget by clicking on: Export current view. These exports generally happen monthly as we reconcile actual spend. If a team member needs a more recent snapshot, please mention @johncoghlan on the developer-relations Slack channel to request an export.

GitLab team members can find the exported Developer Relations budget by searching for the FY22 Developer Relations Budget export document in Google Drive.

How we create our annual budget

Like other teams at GitLab, the Developer Relations team proposes an annual budget to cover the costs necessary for each of its subprograms. This total annual budget is then proposed to Marketing leadership, and to the e-group, for approval.

Once approved, the Developer Relations team then forecasts how much of the total annual budget will be spent each quarter, and if possible, which month each spend will occur. The total annual budget cannot be adjusted except for in special circumstances with approval of the e-group.

Reallocation and adjustments

Adjustments between the quarterly forecasts (moving budget from one quarter to another), can occur up until the specific quarter's forecasts are locked in. This occurs on the last day of the previous quarter (eg. the FY22 Q2 forecast is due on April 30th).

Once a quarter's forecast has been locked, no further adjustment to that quarter's spending is allowed. For example, if the forecasted amount for that quarter is not used up, then that amount is "lost" and cannot be reallocated to another quarter.

Line-item adjustments can occur once the quarterly forecast is locked. To do so, a request needs to be submitted and approved by @johncoghlan for the Developer Relations team.

Managing Expenses and Actual Spend

Each month, the Developer Relations team program managers meet with our partners in Finance to review actual monthly expenses during the monthly Developer Relations Accruals meeting. This process allows us to accurately report our team expenditures vs budget forecasts.

Costs over \$5000 are allocated out month by month for a specified amount of time by the appropriate Community Program Manager.

Costs under \$5000 do not need to be allocated over time, and will be removed from the budget all at once.

Procurement for Community Team

We use Coupa for most procurement requests. For more information, please reference the Procurement Process handbook.

All invoices require a PO number, so vendors must be given the appropriate PO number to include in their invoice. The PO numbers are assigned by the Procurement team. Invoices received without the correct PO number will be rejected and must be resubmitted with the relevant PO number included. For questions, please ask the Procurement Team on Slack: procurement.

Here are the PO numbers that belong to our team so far:

EDU/OSS: PO 40

When filing a procurement issue, you may also be asked for an Allocadia ID number. To get this ID, ask someone with Allocadia access to fill out the details in the line item. Once this is done, an ID will be populated in the top left hand corner of the details panel, where it says Line Item ID.

Tracking swag giveaway expenses

To help our finance team keep track of community swag giveaways, giveaways in Printfection that support Developer Relations programs and events should add Community: as a prefix to the campaign title. Ex: Community: GitLab Heroes + Superheroes Swag.

We use the campaign tag swagcommunity to track our spend in the budget.

There is a recurring maintenance cost of the community program's campaigns on Printfection. Printfection does shipping and handling through prepaid amounts of fixed increments, so the charge won't happen often but will come as part of the costs for the campaigns we run.

Community Event Sponsorship

Please see the Suggesting an Event section of the Events handbook page for more information on we handle sponsorship requests.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/twitter.md

Overview

Handles for social channels

TWITTER HANDLE	RESPOND FROM	GUIDELINES
@GitLabStatus	Zendesk	Post service updates
@GitLab	Zendesk	Respond to mentions and questions

- The @GitLabStatus account should only be used to give updates on the availability of GitLab.com and to follow up on users reporting that GitLab.com is unavailable or responding to a previous availability update on @GitLabStatus.
- Only the infrastructure team should be posting updates on @GitLabStatus. There is a defined process for this describing who should do this, how and what channels should be alerted.

Workflow

- Community Operations should use their best judgment and reply to tweets, in these two cases:
 1. To route users to the forum if they need help with a technical issue or inquiry
 1. Tweet content when asked explicitly to do so by the Social Media Team or the Communications Team

Community Operations uses Zendesk via Zapier to pull in all mentions of GitLab on Twitter. When resolving Twitter tickets in Zendesk you should:

1. Look for technical questions and send them to the forum via twitter response, via Zendesk
1. Look for opportunities for re-tweets that may interest the Social Media Team
1. Look for patterns in negative sentiment indicating a bad community response to an expected of unexpected GitLab change
1. Look for opportunities to engage the Developer Evangelists, or other experts, via the Involving Experts Workflow.

Best practices

Tweets regarding GitLab downtime

Check if we're experiencing any issues with our system on GitLab System Status page or if there were any official updates on our Twitter GitLab.com Status profile. If you find anything that might be related, please follow up with the user forwarding that link and asking if they are still experiencing issues.

Support Related Questions

Often, users will tweet their support related questions to the main @gitlab account. Solving support related questions via twitter is not the preferred method, as the character limit is difficult to work with, and resolutions could be lost for future use.

Instead, please direct users to post their question on the GitLab Forum.

Directing Users to the Forum

Try to find a related topic in the forum (preferably one that is solved!) and share a direct link. If no similar topic exists, share the link to the most appropriate forum category.

Consider using language like this in your tweet to best encourage forum use:

- Posting in the forum allows the GitLab team and the wider community to help find solutions for your needs, create issues for long-term solutions, and update our documentation.
- In order to troubleshoot your issue, please post your question in our forum at <https://forum.gitlab.com>! This way you'll have the whole power of the community to help.
- It's likely these community experts will be able to help: (link to forum topic) since they have worked through something similar before. Post your question and we'll check in on it!

Automation

Tweets that mention @GitLab, or @GitLabStatus will create a ticket in Zendesk, and show up in the "Twitter" view.

If a tweet is responded to from TweetDeck, this risks duplicate responses. Responding from Zendesk also enables us to track our response times vs. our internal SLA.

Tweetdeck

Tweetdeck can be used to delete tweets if something is sent accidentally from Zendesk. If you send an accidental tweet from the @GitLab handle, please notify the Social Media team asap via the socialmediaaction slack channel.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/zapier.md

Zapier subscription

We use Zapier to automate the task of forwarding mentions of GitLab, swag store orders, etc.

The Zapier subscription runs on the Team plan, and is shared with the GitLab team.

Zapier access

- URL: <https://zapier.com>
- Account: search for the shared Zapier account in 1Password's Zapier vault. Please file an

access request if you cannot access that vault.

Once logged in, you can access, edit and create Zaps in the Developer Relations folder

```
{{% alert color="warning" %}}  
<i class="fas fa-hand-point-right" aria-hidden="true" style="color: rgb(138, 109, 59)  
;"></i> After editing or creating a new Zap, remember to turn it on with the toggle switch next  
to the task's name on the Zap's list.  
{{% /alert %}}
```

Current Zaps

List of Zaps that are enabled on the Developer Relations folder.

Zap	Description	Involved Tools
Post new Blogs to the GitLab forum	GitLab blog post is posted as a new forum topic about.gitlab.com/blog, Discourse	

Zaps for Developer Advocacy

The Zaps are organized in the Developer Advocacy folder as a sub-folder for Developer Relations in Zapier.

Zap	Description	Involved Tools
New blog posts - GitLab	Reads GitLab blog RSS feed and posts to developer-advocacy-updates channel. GitLab Blog, Slack	
New blog posts - GitHub	Reads GitHub blog RSS feed and posts to developer-advocacy-updates channel. Additional zap posts to competitive Slack channels. GitHub Blog, Slack	
New blog posts - CNCF	Reads CNCF blog RSS feed and posts to developer-advocacy-updates channel. CNCF Blog, Slack	
New status updates - Discourse	Reads Discourse Status RSS feed and posts to developer-advocacy-updates channel. Discourse status page, Slack	

Zaps for Discourse forum

The Zaps help with automated monitoring to support new product launches.

Zap	Description	Involved Tools
New forum topics with catalog or component	Reads Discourse forum RSS feed https://forum.gitlab.com/latest.rss and posts to fcicatalog channel. Discourse forum, Slack	
New forum topics in the GitLab Duo category	Reads Discourse forum RSS feed https://forum.gitlab.com/c/gitlab-duo.rss and posts to gitlab-duo-forum-posts channel. Discourse forum, Slack	

Zaps for Hacker News

The Zaps are organized in the Developer Advocacy folder as a sub-folder for Developer Relations

in Zapier.

| Zap | Description | Involved Tools |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Hackernews: Slack notifications for front page mentions: GitLab | Hackernews: GitLab front page stories to dev-advocacy-team Slack channel. Adds Hacker News response workflow URL. | HackerNews, Slack |

| Hackernews: Slack notifications for front page mentions: Open Core | Hackernews: Open Core front page stories to dev-advocacy-team Slack channel. Adds Hacker News response workflow URL. | HackerNews, Slack |

| Hackernews: Slack Notifications for mentions: GitLab | Hackernews: GitLab mentions to hn-mentions Slack channel | HackerNews, Slack |

| Hackernews: Slack Notifications for mentions: DevOps Platform | Hackernews: DevOps Platform mentions to hn-mentions Slack channel | HackerNews, Slack |

The Zaps poll the Algolia search API for Hacker News and add specific URL parameters in order to

- Query for a string in the posts; ?query="open%20core"
- Filter by tags if the topic hit the front page of Hacker News: &tags=frontpage

Searching for a string with whitespaces requires to use quotes around the query parameter, for example <https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/search?&query=%22open%20core%22&tags=frontpage>.

More API URL examples:

- Front page: <https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/search?&query=gitlab&tags=frontpage>
- Mentions: [https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/searchbydate?query="devops+platform"](https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/searchbydate?query='devops+platform')

gitlab-blog Forum Bot

The gitlab-blog user is used to automatically post new GitLab blogs as a new topic to the Community category. This process is controlled through Zapier. Zapier reads the blog RSS feed at <https://about.gitlab.com/atom.xml> and posts a new topic using the admin API key and gitlab-blog user for each new entry there.

The gitlab-blog credentials and admin API key are stored in the 1Password Marketing vault. Admins can directly edit the user in Discourse without login.

Troubleshooting

Slack message misses data from Hacker News

Open the Zap, and inspect the Send Channel Message in Slack action. If the Message Text section contains placeholder variables with errors, inspect the data source. It may happen that the data retrieval in Zapier was broken in a step before, for example in Retrieve Polls in Webhooks by Zapier.

Example: The Open Core Hacker News frontpage Zap does not provide data fields, and refreshing the fields for the URL [https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/search?&query="open+core"&tags=frontpage](https://hn.algolia.com/api/v1/search?&query='open+core'&tags=frontpage)

does not bring up any result records to continue.

Fix: Temporarily change the search to a value which is currently on the Hacker News front page, and refresh the fields in Zapier. Fix the Slack message variable placeholders, and publish the Zap. Immediately edit the Zap again, and change the search query to the original value (open+core).

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/zendesk.md

Developer Relations Zendesk instance

The Developer Relations team uses a dedicated Zendesk instance to centralize the management of relevant community mentions, and to process Education Program, Open Source Program, and Startup Program applications and requests. This instance is separate from other Zendesk instances GitLab uses.

The majority of cases in Zendesk are routed there via Zapier automation, or a native Zendesk integration.

Each case is then converted into a Zendesk ticket and filtered into a View, ordered by category. As part of their daily workflow, the Community Operations Team, and the Education and Open Source Program Managers monitor these views and process tickets through completion.

Zendesk subscription

After a discussion with the GitLab Support team, it was concluded that for the specific Developer Relations workflows and metrics it would be best to keep the Developer Relations Zendesk instance separate from the Support team's Zendesk instance.

The Developer Relations instance runs on a Professional Zendesk Support subscription, with one Agent seat per Developer Relations team member, plus extra seats for the team manager and collaborators. Additionally, the Collaboration Add-on provides us extra seats for Light Agents with read-only access to tickets.

Adding new agent seats to existing subscription

- If there is a need to increase the number of agent seats, contact the GitLab Account Manager at Zendesk. Their details are in the Developer Relations - Zendesk contact secure note in 1Password, on the Marketing vault.
- Account billing details (only accessible by the Zendesk instance owner)

After the initial contact and agreeing to the subscription plan update:

1. The GitLab Account Manager at Zendesk sends the unsigned service order to the DRI at GitLab via e-mail.
1. DRI submits a finance issue following the Procure to pay process, attaching the unsigned

service order. See this existing subscription add-on issue for reference.

1. DRI works with stakeholders to complete the approval chain
1. DRI reaches back to the GitLab Account Manager at Zendesk and asks them to:
 1. Please send the DocuSign contract to our CFO to sign. His e-mail address is: {ADDCFOEMAIL}
 2. Please add the comment: "Approved by GitLab at {ADDFINANCEISSUELINK}" to the DocuSign e-mail
 3. Please add me as CC on the DocuSign document so that I have visibility of it and get a notification when it's been signed by GitLab
1. DRI uploads signed contract to ContractWorks after CFO signature.

Zendesk access

Zendesk access is provided during onboarding for members of the Developer Relations team when needed. Access as an Agent (read/write access to tickets) or a Light Agent (read-only access to tickets) can also be provided for other team members using the access request process if needed.

Once access is set up:

1. Go to <https://gitlab-community.zendesk.com>
1. Log in as "Agent" via SSO and your GitLab Google Workspace account.

Provisioning agents

To add an Agent:

1. Log into Zendesk
1. Go to Settings > Manage > People
1. Click on add agent
1. Fill in name and e-mail address
1. Choose the role, either Agent (read/write access to tickets) Light Agent (read-only access to tickets, but can leave internal notes)
1. Click Add
1. Choose the relevant groups for the new agent, and optionally set their time zone

Deprovisioning agents or changing roles

To find a user account and edit their status:

1. Log into Zendesk
1. Go to Settings > Manage > People
1. Enter their e-mail on the search box and click on Search
1. When the user appears on the list of results, click on Edit

To change the role for an account (e.g. promote or demote as Admin):

1. Follow steps above to find a user account and edit status
1. Click on the Role dropdown on the left
1. Select the appropriate role. The status is saved automatically upon change.

To deprovision (remove agent status):

1. Follow steps above to find a user account and edit status
1. Click on the Role dropdown on the left
1. Set the role to End User (no read/write access). The status is saved automatically upon change.

Zendesk views

View limits workaround

There is a limit on the number of views that can be displayed on the main "Views" panel on Zendesk, regardless of the type of subscription:

- 12 shared views
- 8 personal views

If the number of views exceeds these limits, the additional views are moved to the Settings > Views panel. As the Community Operations Manager makes use of the shared views feature, and as the number of response channels already exceeds the limit of 12, this poses a hindrance on ticket visibility and effectivity.

As a workaround, the team has decided to standardize our personal views, thus effectively increasing the number of visible Views to 20. If the number of response channels exceed the count of 20, an alternative approach could be to consolidate some of the existing views - a practice already followed where it makes sense (e.g. E-mail view).

The workaround is based on two steps: creating a shared view, which then can be cloned as a personal view.

Creating new shared views

To create a new shared view:

1. Navigate to Settings > Views
1. Click on the Add view button or clone an existing shared view
1. Set up or modify the filter conditions if necessary
1. On Available for, choose All agents
1. Inform the rest of the team about the availability of the new view

Cloning shared views as personal views

To create a personal view from a shared view:

1. Navigate to Settings > Views
1. In the views list, hover over the right hand side of view you want to clone
1. Click on the ellipsis to open the context menu
1. Choose Clone

1. Do not modify the filter conditions
1. On Available for, choose Me only

Zendesk macros

A macro is similar to an email template and consists of one or more actions that modify the values of a Zendesk ticket's fields. Macros are applied to tickets manually from the drop down within each message.

While macros provide template responses, please keep in mind that the goal is to personalize each response as much as possible in order to provide excellent service to our community.

Macros can perform the following tasks:

- Add comment text
- Update ticket fields
- Add or remove ticket tags
- Add CCs
- Change the assignee
- Set the ticket subject
- Add attachments to ticket comments

Creating macros

There are two types of macros: personal macros (created by an agent or administrator for their own use) and shared macros (created by an administrator with permission for multiple users).

Please make sure to focus on creating shared macros since we want to keep all the info transparent and available to the whole team.

Tips:

- If you are creating a new Macro, open an existing one in another tab so you can see the formatting and all of the Actions you should add.
- If you think you need Admin access, let your manager know.
- Without Admin access, you can create Macros that are available only to you (e.g a Macro with your personal email signature).

Creating personal macros

Although only administrators can create the macros that are shared by all, we can also create personal macros. A personal macro is only visible to and can only be used or modified by the creator.

1. Click the Admin icon in the sidebar, then select Macros.
1. Click the All shared macros drop-down menu and select Personal macros.
1. Click the Add macro button.
1. Enter the macro name, and add actions for your macro as described in Building macro action statements.
1. Click Create.

Creating shared macros

Administrators (and agents in custom roles with permission) can create macros that are shared by all Zendesk Support agents or macros that are shared by only agents in a specific group. Administrators can also create personal macros for their own use.

A personal macro is only visible to and can only be used or modified by the creator. Administrators can create shared macros, and can modify all shared macros, regardless of who created them.

1. Click the Admin icon in the sidebar, then select Macros.
1. Click the Add macro button.
1. Enter a Macro name.
1. (Optional) Enter a Description.
1. Select an option from the Availab